

able by appliance designers for larger displays. If water is pooling when the user touches the screen or if a larger drop falls onto the horizontal screen, false touches induced by water should be suppressed and normal single finger operation should be supported. Designers should design to avoid false touch events from highly conductive liquids like salt water and even cleaning solutions like bleach. Fig. 2 provides a brief look at what happens behind the display panel.

Gloves. Users use thin or thick gloves fairly often in the kitchen or laundry rooms, especially when a kitchen sink needs to interface with a refrigerator or stove touch screen. HMI touch screen technology needs to start supporting glove use. Today, several such capabilities on touch screen ICs used in home appliances are often overlooked but could provide significant value to the end-user. When turned on and tuned during the development stage, the optional glove support feature in the controller could provide multi-touch (up to ten touches) for gloves typically used in

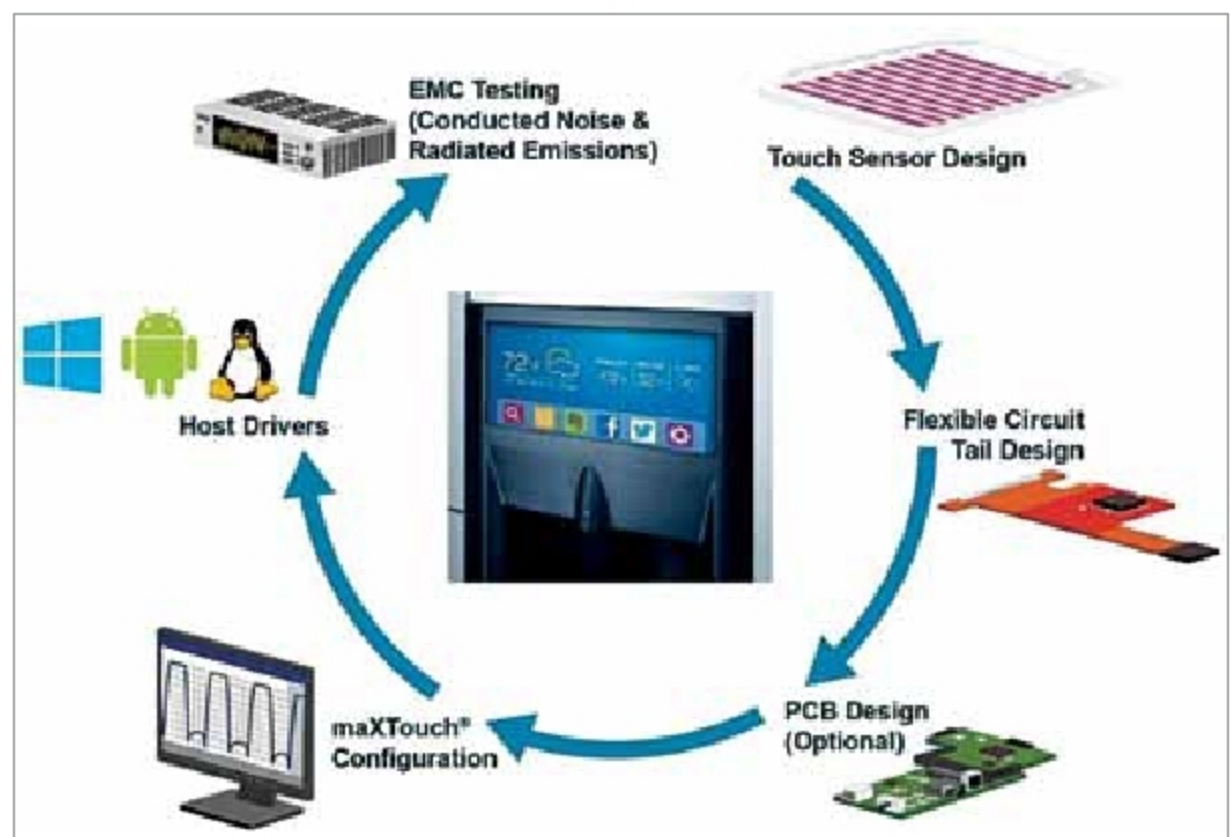


Fig. 3: In addition to the touch IC, the touch IC provider performs many functions behind the scenes to bring a successful touch screen to the market

kitchens (about 1.5mm thick). For cooking, thick (up to 5mm) gloves or oven mitts often made of silicone are used. With glove support, the controller can still provide accurate input to the HMI. This can occur

automatically without the need to enter a separate mode and return to the normal sensing level when a glove is not used.

In contrast, some controllers require users to select between modes

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